SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

13 September 2023 · Shift 2

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 42 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.18

Ramesh purchased a bag for ₹1,275 and sold it at a gain of 15% but calculated on the selling price. Find the selling price of the bag.

(A) ₹1,325
(B) ₹1,400
(C) ₹1,475
(D) ₹1,500

General Awareness 23 questions

Q.1

The novel ‘God of Small Things’ is a creation of which novelist?

(A) Kamala Das
(B) Amrita Pritam
(C) Ashapurna Devi
(D) Arundhati Roy

Q.2

Which of the following terms best describes the average number of runs a batter makes per 100 deliveries in cricket?

(A) Economy rate
(B) Batting average
(C) Strike rate
(D) Batting rate

Q.3

Yuki Bhambri and Saketh Myneni won the Bangkok Open Challenger title 2023. They are related to which sport?

(A) Badminton
(B) Squash
(C) Tennis
(D) Table Tennis

Q.4

Deba Prasad Das, Pankaj Charan Das and Gangadhar Pradhan are associated with which of the following dance forms?

(A) Odissi
(B) Bharatanatyam
(C) Manipuri
(D) Kathak

Q.5

Which of the following is NOT a fundamental duty listed in the Indian Constitution?

(A) To uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India
(B) To engage in political activities to promote democracy
(C) To value and preserve the rich heritage of our composite culture
(D) To safeguard public property and to abjure violence

Q.6

As of 2022, 12-feet statue of Adi Shankaracharya, which was unveiled by the Prime Minister of India is located in _____

(A) Pune
(B) Ahmedabad
(C) Varanasi
(D) Kedarnath

Q.7

During cell division, the formation of a new cell wall is followed by the accumulation of:

(A) peristome
(B) periplasm
(C) phragmoplast
(D) protoplast

Q.8

Bhanu Ji is associated with which of the following Gharanas of Kathak?

(A) Lucknow
(B) Raigarh
(C) Banaras
(D) Jaipur

Q.9

Which of the following is an example of capital expenditure in the government budget?

(A) Interest payment on a loan
(B) Purchase of military equipment
(C) Maintenance of government buildings
(D) Subsidies provided to farmers

Q.10

FIH Men's Hockey World Cup 2023 was held in which Indian state/UT?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) New Delhi
(C) Odisha
(D) Gujarat

Q.11

An image of which of the following elements is shown by the map of Cyprus from which the element got its name?

(A) Silver
(B) Cobalt
(C) Copper
(D) Sulphur

Q.13

The Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan (PMGKRA) was launched in the year 2020 by which Ministry of Government of India?

(A) Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways
(B) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
(C) Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
(D) Ministry of Rural Development

Q.14

Who among the following is the author of the Hindi novel ‘Raag Darbari’?

(A) Shrilal Shukla
(B) Rahul Sankrityayan
(C) Premchand
(D) Kashinath Singh

Q.15

Who is the first female classical dancer in Indian history to be nominated as a Member of Rajya Sabha, the upper house of the Parliament of India?

(A) Mukti Mohan
(B) Shobha Naidu
(C) Sanjukta Panigrahi
(D) Rukmini Devi Arundale

Q.16
What does the term ‘Overdraft’ mean in banking?

(A) The process of transferring funds between bank accounts
(B) The maximum withdrawal limit from an ATM
(C) Short-term financing facility
(D) The interest charged on loans

Q.17
Which of the following is an example of Eastern Ghats peak?

(A) Doddabetta
(B) Mahendragiri
(C) Guru Shikhar
(D) Anamudi

Q.18
Indian musician, Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasia used to play which of the following musical instruments?

(A) Veena
(B) Flute
(C) Sarangi
(D) Guitar

Q.19
Which of the following was the first major and decisive victory for the East India Company on the soil of India?

(A) Battle of Sindhuli
(B) First Anglo-Maratha War
(C) Battle of Plassey
(D) Battle of Tiruvannamalai

Q.20
Which of the following locations receives the most rainfall in India?

(A) Prayagraj
(B) Guwahati
(C) Jaisalmer
(D) Mawsynram

Q.21
According to the Census of India 2011, what was the literacy rate recorded in Kerala?

(A) 85.8%
(B) 90.3%
(C) 87.9%
(D) 94.0%

Q.22
The Digital Lok Adalat, powered by AI (Artificial Intelligence) and Blockchain, was launched by the then National Legal Services Authority Chairman _____ during the 18th All India Legal Services Authorities’ meet held in Jaipur in July 2022.

(A) Justice RN Mishra
(B) Justice DY Chandrachud
(C) Justice AS Anand
(D) Justice Uday Umesh Lalit

Q.24
Which of the following music directors is known as ‘Mozart of Madras’?

(A) AR Rahman
(B) Madan Mohan
(C) RD Burman
(D) Himesh Reshammiya

Q.25
What is the tenure of the Vice-President of India?

(A) Until the age of 65
(B) Until he wants to hold the office
(C) 6 years
(D) 5 years

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If I hand her a flower and say, “Give it to mamma,” she “take it” to her mother.

(A) was taking it
(B) takes it
(C) had took it
(D) had taken it

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Divergent

(A) Addition
(B) Similar
(C) Disrespectful
(D) Obvious

Q.3

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. “To much” seriousness “hardens the” “world, pinning” it down “with rules.”

(A) with rules
(B) hardens the
(C) to much
(D) world, pinning

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. He managed to save his father’s business by “the sweat of his brow”.

(A) incidentally
(B) hard work
(C) tricks and strategies
(D) any way possible

Q.5

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given phrase. A place where water is collected and stored for future use.

(A) Aquarium
(B) Resort
(C) Sanatorium
(D) Reservoir

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The new chairman of the company “announced attracted bonus for the employees” on the occasion of the new year.

(A) No improvement required
(B) announced an attractive bonus for the employees
(C) announcing attracted bonus for the employees
(D) announced attracting bonus for the employees

Q.7

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) The institute / (B) have been / (C) divided into / (D) multiple departments

(A) A
(B) B
(C) C
(D) D

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. They allowed us to “powder by crushing” the spices, pick over the raisins and lick the stirring spoons.

(A) gain
(B) greet
(C) guess
(D) grind

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Mild

(A) Scathing
(B) Brittle
(C) Gentle
(D) Severe

Q.10

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Instead of answering the question directly, the politician kept _____.

(A) crying over spilt milk
(B) pointing at his laurels
(C) beating around the bush
(D) spilling the bean

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Rishi asked Karan “will he get a new football for him?”

(A) would he get a new football for him?
(B) if he would get a new football for him.
(C) if would he get a new football for him?
(D) if he will get a new football for him?

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Omitted
(B) Retrospact
(C) Conscience
(D) Admission

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Often

(A) Generally
(B) Rarely
(C) Periodically
(D) Usually

Q.14

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. The boy whose the sister is ill has left.

(A) is ill
(B) has left
(C) The boy
(D) whose the sister

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A strong _____ for mathematics and problem-solving can be very useful.

(A) strength
(B) aptitude
(C) functioning
(D) perception

Q.17

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. My manager forced me to resign from my job as a chef since I underwent a spine surgery. I was depressed and had lost all hope. Later my father motivated me to open my own café and showed me ways to be independent. After all it is true that one should not _____.

(A) grease the palm
(B) blow one’s own trumpet
(C) cry over spilt milk
(D) blow hot and cold

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. He was “quaking in his boots” when he had to give a speech on the stage.

(A) To tremble in excitement
(B) To shake in happiness
(C) To tremble with fear
(D) To shake in excitement

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. If I "will get" good marks, my father will buy me a laptop.

(A) No substitution required
(B) am getting
(C) gets
(D) get

Q.20

Four words of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains a spelling error. Human activities that "release" longlived greenhouse gases into the atmosphere also "leed" to the enhancement of "concentrations" of shorterlived ozone and "particulate" matter in the atmosphere.

(A) concentrations
(B) particulate
(C) release
(D) leed

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fruits and vegetables contain important vitamins, minerals and plant (1)_____. They also contain fibre. There are many (2)_____ of fruits and vegetables available and many ways to prepare, cook and serve them. A diet (3)_____ in fruit and vegetables can help protect you against cancer, diabetes and heart disease. Eat five kinds of vegetable and two kinds of fruit every day for good health. Most Indians do not eat (4)_____ fruit and vegetables. When buying and serving fruit and vegetables, aim for variety to get the most (5)_____ and appeal.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) residue
(B) bacteria
(C) chemicals
(D) organisms

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fruits and vegetables contain important vitamins, minerals and plant (1)_____. They also contain fibre. There are many (2)_____ of fruits and vegetables available and many ways to prepare, cook and serve them. A diet (3)_____ in fruit and vegetables can help protect you against cancer, diabetes and heart disease. Eat five kinds of vegetable and two kinds of fruit every day for good health. Most Indians do not eat (4)_____ fruit and vegetables. When buying and serving fruit and vegetables, aim for variety to get the most (5)_____ and appeal.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) traits
(B) characters
(C) varieties
(D) uses

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fruits and vegetables contain important vitamins, minerals and plant (1)_____. They also contain fibre. There are many (2)_____ of fruits and vegetables available and many ways to prepare, cook and serve them. A diet (3)_____ in fruit and vegetables can help protect you against cancer, diabetes and heart disease. Eat five kinds of vegetable and two kinds of fruit every day for good health. Most Indians do not eat (4)_____ fruit and vegetables. When buying and serving fruit and vegetables, aim for variety to get the most (5)_____ and appeal.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) immersed
(B) rich
(C) content
(D) varied

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fruits and vegetables contain important vitamins, minerals and plant (1)_____. They also contain fibre. There are many (2)_____ of fruits and vegetables available and many ways to prepare, cook and serve them. A diet (3)_____ in fruit and vegetables can help protect you against cancer, diabetes and heart disease. Eat five kinds of vegetable and two kinds of fruit every day for good health. Most Indians do not eat (4)_____ fruit and vegetables. When buying and serving fruit and vegetables, aim for variety to get the most (5)_____ and appeal.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) some
(B) enough
(C) many
(D) plenty

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Fruits and vegetables contain important vitamins, minerals and plant (1)_____. They also contain fibre. There are many (2)_____ of fruits and vegetables available and many ways to prepare, cook and serve them. A diet (3)_____ in fruit and vegetables can help protect you against cancer, diabetes and heart disease. Eat five kinds of vegetable and two kinds of fruit every day for good health. Most Indians do not eat (4)_____ fruit and vegetables. When buying and serving fruit and vegetables, aim for variety to get the most (5)_____ and appeal.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) assortment
(B) fun
(C) nutrients
(D) advancement

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.18 **(D)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**	

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.18 · Answer (D) ₹1,500

With the gain at 15% of the selling price, the cost price is 85% of it: SP = 1,275/0.85 = ₹1,500.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Arundhati Roy

'The God of Small Things' (1997), which won the Booker Prize that year, is Arundhati Roy's first novel.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Strike rate

Strike rate = runs scored ÷ balls faced × 100. Batting average is runs per dismissal, and economy rate is the runs a bowler concedes per over.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Tennis

Yuki Bhambri and Saketh Myneni are Indian tennis players; they won the men's doubles at the Bangkok Open, an ATP Challenger tournament played at Nonthaburi, Thailand, in January 2023.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Odissi

Deba Prasad Das, Pankaj Charan Das and Gangadhar Pradhan were gurus of Odissi, Odisha's classical dance; the first two were among the gurus who revived the form in the mid-20th century.

Q.5 · Answer (B) To engage in political activities to promote democracy

Upholding the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India, preserving the heritage of our composite culture, and safeguarding public property and abjuring violence are fundamental duties under Article 51A; political activity is not one of them.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Kedarnath

Prime Minister Narendra Modi unveiled the 12-foot statue of Adi Shankaracharya at his samadhi at Kedarnath, Uttarakhand, in November 2021.

Q.7 · Answer (C) phragmoplast

SSC's key gives phragmoplast: in a dividing plant cell a framework of microtubules, the phragmoplast, gathers between the two daughter nuclei, and vesicles brought to it fuse into the cell plate from which the new cell wall grows. It forms before the plate and keeps re-forming at the plate's growing edge, so the question puts the order loosely, but none of the other options has any part in forming the wall.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Jaipur

Bhanuji, a devotee of Shiva, is regarded as the founder of the Jaipur gharana of Kathak.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Purchase of military equipment

Buying military equipment creates assets, so it is capital expenditure. Interest payments, the upkeep of buildings and subsidies create no assets and are revenue expenditure.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Odisha

The 2023 FIH Men's Hockey World Cup was held in Odisha, at Bhubaneswar and Rourkela, in January 2023.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Copper

Copper takes its name, through the Latin 'cuprum', from Cyprus, a chief source of the metal in the ancient world; the map of the island on the Cypriot flag is coloured copper-orange for it.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Ministry of Rural Development

The Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan, launched in June 2020 to give work to migrant workers who had gone back to their villages during the Covid-19 lockdown, had the Ministry of Rural Development as its nodal ministry.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Shrilal Shukla
'Raag Darbari' (1968), a satire on village politics in Uttar Pradesh, is by Shrilal Shukla; it won the Sahitya Akademi Award in 1969.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Rukmini Devi Arundale
Rukmini Devi Arundale, the Bharatanatyam dancer who founded Kalakshetra in 1936, was nominated to the Rajya Sabha in 1952, the first Indian woman to be nominated to it.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Short-term financing facility
An overdraft lets an account holder draw more than the balance in the account, up to an agreed limit, as short-term credit on which interest is charged.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Mahendragiri
Mahendragiri, about 1,500 m high in Gajapati district, Odisha, is a peak of the Eastern Ghats. Doddabetta is in the Nilgiris, Anamudi in the Western Ghats and Guru Shikhar in the Aravallis.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Flute
Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is India's best-known player of the bansuri, the bamboo flute of Hindustani classical music.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Battle of Plassey
At Plassey in June 1757 Robert Clive's forces defeated Siraj-ud-Daulah, the Nawab of Bengal, helped by Mir Jafar's defection; the victory laid the foundation of British power in Bengal.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Mawsynram
Mawsynram, in the East Khasi Hills of Meghalaya, has the highest average annual rainfall in India; Jaisalmer, in the Thar Desert, is among the driest places.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 94.0%
In the 2011 Census Kerala had the highest literacy rate of any state, 94.0%.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Justice Uday Umesh Lalit
Justice U. U. Lalit, then Executive Chairman of the National Legal Services Authority, launched the Digital Lok Adalat at the meet in Jaipur in July 2022; he became Chief Justice of India the next month.

Q.24 · Answer (A) AR Rahman
A. R. Rahman, the composer from Chennai (Madras), is widely called the 'Mozart of Madras'.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 5 years
Under Article 67 the Vice-President holds office for five years from the day he enters upon it, and stays on until a successor takes office.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) takes it
The singular 'she' takes 'takes' in the present simple, which matches 'hand' and 'say' in this statement of what usually happens.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Similar
'Divergent' means differing or moving apart; its opposite is 'similar' (or 'convergent').

Q.3 · Answer (C) to much
'Too', not 'to', means more than is wanted: 'Too much seriousness hardens the world'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) hard work
To do something 'by the sweat of one's brow' is to do it through one's own hard work.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Reservoir
A 'reservoir' is a natural or artificial place where water is collected and stored; an aquarium holds fish, a sanatorium treats the sick and a resort is a holiday place.

Q.6 · Answer (B) announced an attractive bonus for the employees
The singular 'bonus' needs the article 'an', and the adjective 'attractive' (appealing) is the word that describes it: 'announced an attractive bonus for the employees'. 'Attracted' and 'attracting' do not mean appealing, and 'announcing' leaves the sentence without a main verb.

Q.7 · Answer (B) B
'The institute' is singular and takes 'has been': 'The institute has been divided into multiple departments.'

Q.8 · Answer (D) grind
To 'grind' spices is to crush them to powder: 'They allowed us to grind the spices'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Gentle
'Mild' means not harsh or strong: 'gentle'. 'Severe' and 'scathing' are nearly its opposites.

Q.10 · Answer (C) beating around the bush
To 'beat around the bush' is to avoid coming to the point, as the politician did instead of answering directly.

Q.11 · Answer (B) if he would get a new football for him.
A reported yes/no question is introduced with 'if', puts the subject before the verb, moves 'will' back to 'would' after the past 'asked', and ends with a full stop: 'Rishi asked Karan if he would get a new football for him.'

Q.12 · Answer (B) Retrospact
The correct spelling is 'retrospect'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Rarely
'Often' means many times; its opposite is 'rarely'. 'Usually' and 'generally' are close to it in meaning.

Q.14 · Answer (D) whose the sister
'Whose' already acts as a determiner, so no article follows it: 'The boy whose sister is ill has left.'

Q.15 · Answer (B) aptitude
An 'aptitude' is a natural ability, and it takes 'for': 'a strong aptitude for mathematics'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) cry over spilt milk
'Don't cry over spilt milk' means there is no use regretting what cannot be undone; the writer stopped grieving over the lost job and opened a café.

Q.18 · Answer (C) To tremble with fear
To be 'quaking in one's boots' is to be very frightened, to tremble with fear.

Q.19 · Answer (D) get
In a first conditional the 'if' clause takes the present simple and the main clause 'will': 'If I get good marks, my father will buy me a laptop.'

Q.20 · Answer (D) leed
The verb is spelt 'lead': the gases also lead to higher concentrations of ozone and particulate matter.

Q.21 · Answer (C) chemicals
The sentence lists useful substances in fruit and vegetables: vitamins, minerals and plant 'chemicals' (phytochemicals). Residue, bacteria and organisms are not what the food is valued for.

Q.22 · Answer (C) varieties
'Many varieties of fruits and vegetables' means many different kinds of them; 'traits' and 'characters' are qualities, not kinds.

Q.23 · Answer (B) rich
A diet 'rich in' something contains a lot of it: 'a diet rich in fruit and vegetables'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) enough
'Enough', as much as is needed, goes straight before the noun: 'do not eat enough fruit and vegetables'. 'Plenty' needs 'of', 'many' does not suit the uncountable 'fruit', and 'some' is unusual in a negative sentence.

Q.25 · Answer (C) nutrients

Eating a variety gets the most 'nutrients', which matches the vitamins and minerals the passage began with.

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